1. Introduction

AnonPDF Pro - User Guide

English translation of the Polish help document

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AnonPDF Pro is a tool for partially or fully removing (redacting) selected content in PDF files. It lets you mark areas in a document that should be removed and then generates a new PDF copy with the redactions applied. This makes it easy to remove sensitive data such as personal information or confidential content before sharing PDF documents with third parties.

2. Installation and Launch

1. Download and install AnonPDF Pro (depending on the distribution method, this may be an MSI/EXE installer or a set of binaries).

2. Make sure the required .NET Framework / .NET Runtime is installed (the exact version depends on the application build).

3. Start the application, e.g., from the desktop shortcut, the Start menu, or directly by running AnonPDFPro.exe.

4. After launch, the main application window should open.

2.5 Activating PRO (upgrading from DEMO)

The activation method depends on the deployment mode.

Standalone version

In standalone mode, activation is done by the end user inside the application:

1. Start AnonPDF Pro.
2. Open the `?` menu and select `Activation`.
3. Select the received license package.
4. Confirm and restart the application.
5. Open `? -> About` and verify that the license status is PRO.

Central (network) version

In central mode, end users do not activate from the menu. Activation is performed by an administrator:

1. Close the application on user workstations.
2. Extract the license package.
3. Copy the license files to the application folder (where `AnonPDFPro.exe` is located).
4. Confirm file replacement if prompted.
5. Start the application again and verify `? -> About`.

Notes: - Keep original filenames and folder structure from the license package. - If the application still runs in DEMO mode, verify file location and folder permissions.

3. Application Interface

The main window consists of the following elements:

- Top menu bar - options for managing projects and files, including:

  - File: open a new PDF, save/open a redaction project, exit the application.

  - Search: quickly move focus to the search field.

  - Options: change appearance, language, and application behavior.

  - Help: open this user guide.

- Right panel - contains the `Page List`, `Thumbnails`, and `Layers` tabs. You can quickly switch pages, thumbnails, and layer attributes there.
- Main preview area - displays the currently selected PDF page and allows you to draw/select areas to be redacted.
- Toolbar - buttons for page navigation, zoom, and selection tools:

  - Page navigation: “First”, “Previous”, “Next”, “Last”.

  - Selection navigation: “First selection”, “Previous selection”, “Next selection”, “Last selection”.

  - Zoom: “Zoom in”, “Zoom out”, “Min” (minimum), “Max” (maximum).

- Page number input - a text box for jumping to a specific page by entering its number.
- Redaction tool group:

  - Cursor mode - selects text, redaction areas, and objects without starting a new redaction area.

  - Marker mode - marks horizontal areas (e.g., narrow strips for removing single text

lines).

- Rectangle mode - marks any rectangular area.

- Button “Clear current page” - removes all selections from the currently displayed page.

- Button “Clear all pages” - removes all selections from every page in the document.

- Project I/O and PDF export controls:

  - Open project - loads a .app project file containing saved redaction areas.

  - Open last PDF and project - loads the most recently used PDF and its .app project.

  - Save project - saves the current selections to the active .app project file.

  - Save project as - saves the current selections to a new .app file at a chosen location.

  - Save PDF (redaction) - generates a new PDF file with the selected areas removed.

4. Getting Started

4.1 Open a PDF

From the menu, select File → Open PDF (or click the “Select PDF” button), then choose the target PDF document.

4.2 Browse pages

Use the page list on the left side (or the navigation buttons such as “Next” / “Previous”) to select the page you want to edit.

4.3 Search

To search within the document:

1. In the left panel, type the text you want to find and press Enter.

2. Use the search navigation buttons to move between search results.

3. Use the “PESEL, KW etc.” button to check whether the document contains identifiers such as PESEL, Land and Mortgage Register number, Polish ID card number, NIP, REGON, KRS, bank account number, email address, postal code, website address, or VIN.

4. Use the “Mark search results…” button to convert found results into redaction areas.

5. To remove a search result, click the “X” button next to it.

Search also works in scanned documents and on images embedded in PDFs. For these documents, the application may first prepare the text for searching, so an indexing message may be visible for a short time.

If a scanned page is slightly skewed, the application tries to align search result positions with the actual text location on the page.

4.4 Mark areas for redaction

To create a redaction area:

1. Select Marker mode or Rectangle mode.

2. Press and hold the left mouse button on the page preview where you want to mark content.

3. In Marker mode you draw a horizontal strip; in Rectangle (box) mode you draw a rectangular area of any size.

4. In Marker mode, hold `CTRL` to switch drawing to rectangular (box) mode.

5. Release the mouse button to confirm the selection.

6. A newly created `box` stays selected immediately. You can adjust its size using the top-left and bottom-right handles.

7. Clicking an existing selection selects it and shows a short note at the top of the view. It does not start drawing another selection inside the existing one.

8. To remove an existing selection (for example, if you added it by accident), right-click inside the selection area.

You can also remove a selected `box` or `marker` with the `DELETE` key. In Cursor mode, clicking an existing redaction area selects it without drawing a new area.

4.5 Preview pending redactions

After you create a selection, the text that will be removed is immediately shaded gray in the preview.

4.6 Save your redaction project

If you want to save the current selection state for later editing, choose Save project or Save project as and select where to store the .app file. When you reopen the PDF and the corresponding .app project, you can continue adding or adjusting redactions.

4.7 Export (redact) the PDF

After marking all required areas, click Save PDF (or File → Save PDF). Select the destination output file. The application generates a new redacted PDF with your selected areas removed.

5. Selections and Navigation

5.1 Page navigation

Use the “First”, “Previous”, “Next”, and “Last” buttons, or enter a page number in the page input box and press Enter. You can rotate the current page with `CTRL + R`.

5.2 Selection navigation

If your document contains many selections, use “First selection”, “Previous selection”, “Next selection”, and “Last selection” to quickly jump between pages that contain redaction areas.

5.3 Zoom and scrolling

- Zoom in / Zoom out: use the “+” and “-” buttons or the “Min / Max” buttons to set minimum/maximum zoom.
- Mouse wheel: scrolling moves the page vertically. When you reach the top/bottom edge, the application automatically switches to the previous/next page.
- CTRL + mouse wheel: zoom out/in.
- F11 switches full-screen mode on or off; ESC exits full-screen mode.

6. Additional Features

6.1 Clearing selections

- `Clear current page` removes all redaction areas from the current page and requires confirmation.
- `Clear all` removes all redaction areas from the entire document and also requires confirmation.

6.2 Signatures

The application provides options related to qualified electronic signatures:

- “Removed” - removes all qualified signatures from the document.
- “Original” - keeps the original signatures, but due to document modifications they will not be verifiable.
- “Report” - adds an extra page listing signature information instead of the original signature visualization.

6.3 Removing pages

- Click the “Trash 1..n” icon in the left panel to mark a selected page range for removal (or to cancel removal).
- Click the “Trash” icon in the left panel to mark a single page for removal. The icon background turns black.

6.4 Black fill

By default, the application removes content located inside the selection area. For images, graphics, or scanned pages, the removed area is filled with white and matches the selection size.

Enabling the `Black fill` option makes the selected areas black in the saved PDF.

6.5 Open after saving

When “Preview after saving” is enabled, the application automatically opens the saved PDF after export.

6.6 Loading a project

You can load a .app project file at any time (for example, prepared by another person or created earlier). This updates the selections in the application to match the loaded project.

Project files with the `.app` extension can also be associated with AnonPDF Pro in Windows, so they can be opened directly from File Explorer.

If the PDF path stored in the project is no longer available, the application also looks for a PDF file with the same name in the `.app` project folder.

6.7 Closing the application

When closing, the application may ask you to confirm exiting, especially if you have unsaved changes.

6.8 Help menu

- “User Guide” - opens this help/instruction content.
- “How to start?” - opens the short quick-start tutorial.
- “About” - shows version information, author, and copyright.

- The new version window can show a change summary and a download link or button when an update is available.

6.9 Creating and managing objects

You can add objects from the `Tools` menu or by using shortcuts:

- `CTRL + SHIFT + A` - add an arrow.
- `CTRL + F` - add a shape.
- `CTRL + G` - add an image.
- `CTRL + K` - add a comment.
- `CTRL + A` - select all visible objects on the active layer of the current page.

When working with objects, you can also use:

- `CTRL + C` - copy the active object or active object group.
- `CTRL + V` - paste an object from the clipboard. The pasted object is created on the active layer, keeps the original stacking order, and can be scaled down automatically if the target page is smaller.
- Object copy and paste also works between two running instances of the application.
- `DELETE` - remove the active object or active object group.
- In the text dialog, you can enable the `Arrow` option for the text box frame.
- For a text arrow, you can set `Arrow line width`, `Head length`, and `Head width`.
- The end of the text arrow can be dragged with the mouse, and the attachment point on the frame updates automatically to corners and side centers.
- Rotating the text does not rotate the arrow end; only the attachment point on the frame is updated.
- Scaling the text also scales the frame and attached arrow as a single object.
- In the shape dialog, the `Limit raster view` option is available for rectangles, ellipses, triangles, and regions.
- This option is not used for redaction. It only limits the visible area of raster objects located below it on the same layer.
- In the preview, the raster fragment inside the shape stays clear while the area outside is dimmed. In the final PDF only the area limited by the shape remains visible.
- While creating multi-point shapes, the application shows a short instruction at the top of the view. The left mouse button adds another point and the right mouse button finishes drawing.

Modifiers while editing objects:

- `ALT` while creating shapes forces proportions: rectangle -> square, ellipse -> circle, triangle -> equilateral.
- `ALT` while resizing an image works symmetrically relative to the object center.
- Texts, arrows, and vector shapes can be scaled using corner handles.
- `SHIFT` while scaling preserves object proportions.
- `ALT` while scaling resizes relative to the object center.
- `SHIFT + ALT` while scaling preserves proportions and keeps the object center fixed.

6.10 Duplicating selections and objects

In the context menu (right mouse button), you can use:

- `Duplicate selection` - for redaction selections.
- `Duplicate object` - for objects (for example text, images, arrows, vector shapes, comments).

After selecting one of these options, a page range dialog is shown:

- `From` / `To` - page range where copies should be created.
- The current source page is skipped automatically.

For duplicated objects, an additional option is available:

- `Delete duplicated objects` - removes duplicated object copies in the selected page range.

6.11 Layers

The application supports working layers for redaction selections and objects.

- The `Layers` tab in the right panel lets you quickly change the active layer, visibility, and lock state.
- Layers can also be grouped by a shared group name.
- A group checkbox lets you change visibility or lock state for all layers in that group with one click.
- If layers in a group have different states, the group checkbox shows a mixed state.
- Double-clicking a group name in the `Layers` tab lets you rename that group.
- `Tools -> Layers` opens the full layer management window.
- In the layer management window you can assign a layer to a group using the `Group` column.
- In the layer management window, the `Export and print only visible layers` option overrides the `Export` column settings.
- New selections and new objects are created on the currently active layer.
- Pasted objects are created on the active layer and keep the source stacking order.
- The `Work` layer is always on top and is not exported to the final PDF.
- Hidden layers cannot be interacted with in the preview.
- Locked layers block moving, editing, scaling, and deleting objects.
- Project import keeps object-to-layer assignments.

6.12 Appearance and accessibility

- You can choose the application theme from the `Options` menu.
- High-contrast themes are available: black-yellow and black-white.
- The application better adapts interface sizes to Windows display scaling.

6.13 Save current view

`File -> Save current view...` saves the currently visible page view to a PNG or BMP image file. This saves the preview image and can be useful for documenting work or quickly sharing a page snapshot.

7. Common Issues and Tips

7.1 Cannot save the output PDF

- Make sure the PDF is not open in another application. The system may block saving if the file is currently in use.
- Choose a different output filename to avoid overwriting the original file.

7.2 Invalid project file format (.app)

Project files (.app) store redaction areas as JSON internally. Make sure you open the correct project file for the currently loaded PDF.

- If you see a message that the project contains more pages than the PDF, load the project into the matching PDF document.

7.3 No selections / Save PDF is disabled

- If "Save PDF" is disabled or nothing is selected, verify that you actually added at least one redaction area.

7.4 Slow performance

- Large documents or a high number of selections can increase processing time, especially on less powerful computers.
- Saving your project and working on smaller parts of the document can reduce memory usage and speed up processing.

8. Summary

AnonPDF Pro provides a quick and intuitive way to remove selected areas in PDF documents. Saving and reloading projects enables staged processing and makes it easier to prepare multiple documents consistently. This helps protect sensitive information when sharing PDF materials.

9. New Features

Recent versions include:

- Printing from the `File` menu (`CTRL+P`) with range options: current page, selected page range, or whole document.

- `Save page range to PDF` in the `File` menu, with the current page prefilled by default.
- Three right-side tabs: `Page List`, `Thumbnails`, and `Layers`.
- Dynamic thumbnail generation plus thumbnail cache for better performance on large documents.
- Improved thumbnail refresh after changing the page filter.
- Thumbnails that also show redaction selections, comments, objects, and pages marked for deletion.
- Text search in scanned documents and images embedded in PDFs.
- Detection of personal data and identifiers also in scanned documents.
- Converting search results from scanned pages into redaction areas.
- Cursor mode for safely selecting text, redaction areas, and objects without accidentally drawing new redactions.
- High-contrast themes: black-yellow and black-white.
- `Save current view...` in the `File` menu.
- Remembering the last selected right-side tab (`Page List` / `Thumbnails` / `Layers`).
- Remembering right panel width between application launches.
- Remembering and restoring scroll positions in right panels (`Page List` and `Thumbnails`) when resuming a project.
- Working layers with separate visibility, lock state, and active layer selection.
- Grouping layers by a shared name, with quick visibility and lock toggles for the whole group.
- Extended context menus for selections and objects (copy, cut, duplicate, remove duplicated copies).
- Corner-handle scaling for single objects and object groups (`SHIFT` - proportional, `ALT` - from center).
- The `Arrow` option in the text dialog, with adjustable arrow line width, head length, and head width.
- The `Limit raster view` option in the shape dialog for rectangles, ellipses, triangles, and regions.
- Object copy and paste through the system clipboard, including between two running application instances, with preserved stacking order.
- `Undo` (`CTRL+Z`) and `Redo` (`CTRL+Y`).
- A short quick-start tutorial available from `? -> How to start?`.